## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** a professional thief is fooled by a cleverer impostor | Situational irony. |
| 2 | **(d)** he steals once a year and politely helps a stranger | Mild character. |
| 3 | **(c)** economical and ironic | Style. |
| 4 | **(d)** it assumed no one would appear and ignored the risk of evidence | A weakness. |
| 5 | **(c)** the woman acts so naturally that he forgets his own illegal presence | Her confidence masks the situation. |
| 6 | **(a)** two thieves choose the same house on the same night | Coincidence drives the plot. |
| 7 | **(d)** Is the story's moral about trust or about greed? | Open interpretive. |
| 8 | **(b)** gentle, amused sympathy | Light satire. |
| 9 | **(d)** trust can be manufactured by confident acting | Trust exploited. |
| 10 | **(c)** sceptical | Doubtful. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | He portrays him as gentle, bookish and honest in manner (1) and makes him the victim of a deeper deceit, so we smile rather than condemn (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Calamities are reported lightly, such as the arrest (1) and this gentle tone amplifies the comedy and irony (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Next to her fraud his crime seems small and gentle (1) so he appears almost innocent by comparison (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Horace trusts a stranger while living by deception himself (1) and the woman exploits that trust, showing how trust can be both virtue and weakness (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Horace deceives society by his respectable life. The woman deceives him with a false identity. The layers of deception create irony and give the plot a comic reversal. | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | The woman looks and speaks like a lady and so Horace accepts her. He assumes status equals honesty. The story warns that status can be faked. | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Her anonymity makes her a figure of cunning and mystery. The reader sees her through Horace's eyes. It keeps the focus on his trust. | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Situational irony: the thief is robbed. Verbal irony: Horace speaks politely to a thief. Dramatic irony: the reader may suspect the woman before Horace does. The three levels enrich the humour. | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | The word 'question' suggests doubt. 'Trust' announces the theme. The reader expects a test of trust and gets a comic lesson. | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Horace acts at once and loses his freedom. The consequence is quick and sharp. The story hints that a moment's thought could have saved him. | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Thesis (1). Horace's trust in a stranger (1). The woman's exploitation (1). Counter-view: some trust is necessary (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** She tricked him (1). He chose to commit a crime (1). His fingerprints were his own fault (1). Responsibility is shared (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **20** | Situational irony (1). Verbal irony (1). Dramatic irony (1). Irony in the ending (1). Overall effect (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Clear opening (1). Character and desire (1). The tempting offer (1). The deception revealed (1). Moral ending (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Calling Horace Danby a professional thief; he is a **respectable locksmith** who steals once a year to buy rare books.
- Writing that Horace opened the safe at the Grange for his own plan; he opened it for the **young lady** who tricked him with a false story.
- Saying the lady was the owner's wife; she was a **thief** in disguise, while the real wife was a grey-haired woman of sixty.
- Missing the clue of his **fingerprints**: he took off his gloves to give her the lighter and opened the safe without them.
- Stating the title's meaning wrongly: the 'question of trust' is whether to trust a stranger; Horace trusted too easily and was *caught*.
- Spelling slips: *Horace Danby, locksmith, Shotover Grange, fingerprints, hay fever*; and 'honour among thieves'.

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(a)** it adds comedy and shows human weakness | A comic imperfection. |
| 2 | **(a)** foil | She contrasts with him. |
| 3 | **(d)** a person who pretends to be someone else | Impostor. |
| 4 | **(a)** none; it is humorous about her cunning | She is a rogue, enjoyed comically. |
| 5 | **(c)** its neat reversal depends on a convenient coincidence | Plausible critique. |
| 6 | **(c)** justice can be ironic and law may punish the less clever | Irony. |
| 7 | **(c)** mistaken trust leads to a series of comic misfortunes | Errors of judgement. |
| 8 | **(d)** a third conditional with inversion | Inverted conditional. |
| 9 | **(a)** introducing the character's double life | Exposition. |
| 10 | **(a)** failure to doubt a convenient story | Naivety. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Books stand for culture and honesty (1) but he steals to buy them, a contradiction that gives the story humour (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | It is third-person and ironic (1) and it observes Horace with amused detachment while giving his thoughts (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | It resolves the plot with comic justice (1) and adds depth by giving Horace the books he loves, a final ironic twist (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | They are the physical proof that traps Horace (1) and show that carelessness undoes careful planning (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | People trust those who appear confident and who offer a plausible reason. Horace's wish to help makes him lower his guard. The story shows that trust needs verification. | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | At the start Horace is a free man planning a theft. At the end he is imprisoned but contented. The reversal of fortune completes the irony. | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | A harsh moral may annoy readers. By wrapping it in humour the writer lets us accept it with a smile. We remember the lesson more easily. | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Horace is an amateur motivated by a hobby and a gentle nature. The woman is a professional motivated by profit. Her skill defeats his innocence. The contrast adds to the irony. | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | The woman is the active agent of the plot. She tests Horace and proves his weakness. Without her, the theme of trust would have no test. | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** It reveals the truth to the police and confirms the woman's fraud. It also shows how fast the situation reversed. It completes the proof of Horace's mistake. | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Introduction (1). Lesson from Horace (1). Online scams (1). Precautions (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Gentle manners (1). Love of books (1). Mild crime (1). Being cheated (1). Humour (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Both use gentle humour (1). Here the humour is ironic situation (1). There it is affectionate satire (1). Both teach a lesson (1). Judgement (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Horace's detailed plan (1). The unplanned woman (1). Role of chance (1). Effect on plot (1). Evaluation (1). | 2+2+1 |

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- Saying the lady was the owner's wife; she was a **thief** in disguise, while the real wife was a grey-haired woman of sixty.
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## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(a)** wry | Wry amusement. |
| 2 | **(a)** excessive trust and greed bring downfall | Theme. |
| 3 | **(d)** poetic justice with a twist | Punishment becomes pleasure. |
| 4 | **(a)** to be hoist with one's own petard | Caught in his own scheme. |
| 5 | **(b)** leave a smile and a lesson | Comic. |
| 6 | **(a)** a thief is both victim and offender | Horace is both. |
| 7 | **(c)** a refined passion that leads him astray | Culture and crime. |
| 8 | **(a)** The inspector said that his fingerprints were everywhere. | Pronoun and tense shift. |
| 9 | **(b)** absent in this story | The woman betrays him. |
| 10 | **(a)** its irony and moral | Irony depends on her deceit. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Horace's careful plan is upset by an unplanned meeting (1) so chance can defeat the best preparation (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | She uses plausible details and confident behaviour (1) and takes advantage of Horace's wish to be helpful (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | It warns against trust in strangers and against crime (1) but it is told so lightly that the lesson is humorous rather than preachy (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Foolish: he trusts too easily and leaves prints (1). Unlucky: he meets a more skilled thief; overall both play a part (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | It gently mocks the idea that respectable people cannot be criminals and that criminals cannot be gullible. It does not attack a class strongly. It is mild satire. | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | The thief was completely fooled by the woman. The passive foregrounds the thief and his humiliation, which suits the ironic focus. | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | She would call him a helpful fool and laugh at his politeness. She would note his skill with the safe. She would claim her victory as skill. | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** The break-in and the arrival of the woman create tension. Horace's sneezes and politeness bring laughter. The mixture gives a light-hearted thriller. | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Horace was careful; however, he left fingerprints. Although he was polite, he was a thief. | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Passion for books drives Horace to crime and loss of freedom. A passion needs limits. The story suggests that even good tastes can lead to harm if pursued wrongly. | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Format (1). Governor's curiosity (1). Horace's love of books (1). Humour (1). Ending (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Format (1). Introduction (1). Example (1). Advice (1). Closing (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Exposition: Horace's double life (1). Complication: the woman (1). Climax: opening the safe (1). Resolution: arrest and prison (1). Effect (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** State position (1). Punishment: prison (1). Reward: library (1). Irony of mixture (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |

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